As an example, teams maintaining third-party or public APIs can simply upload a copy of their OpenAPI specification to PactFlow, and this specification acts as their contract already. They just need to use Pact's can-i-deploy tool to have that safety net so that they can deploy their changes safely to production, especially after introducing big changes. In addition, if you follow a more API-first design workflow, data providers can upload their contract immediately without waiting for the consumer to upload their contract.

CDCT REQUIRES ACCESS TO THE CODEBASE

Implementing CDCT requires you to co-locate the tests to the codebase itself. While this is one of the recommended practices when it comes to writing automated tests, we acknowledge that there are situations when some testers or other roles don't have access to the codebase. PDCT, on the other hand, allows team members who aren't confident with their programming skills to get started with contract testing. For example, if they have a copy of the OpenAPI specification, they just need to upload this to PactFlow, and PactFlow will verify on their behalf.

11.1.3 Drawbacks with PDCT

While PDCT addresses the problems found in a CDCT approach, there are still drawbacks that you need to be aware of. We recommend that you take the time to understand your project requirements and first consider if a CDCT approach fits your needs instead.

PACTFLOW EXCLUSIVITY

As mentioned already, PDCT (bi-directional) is a feature exclusive to PactFlow. While PactFlow has a free starting plan, it's limited. If you and your team require more contracts to be uploaded, then an enhanced pricing plan is needed. Check out https://pactflow.io/pricing/for PactFlow's pricing information.